

A calmer Money plan

A research-backed visual system for funding, spending, tax reserves, savings, and pension goals.

THE DECISION

Funding progress stays green. Spending pressure gets its own meter. Red means money is genuinely over or overdue - never merely incomplete.

Why this matters

The current row makes a healthy Rent envelope look dangerous because one bar mixes funding completeness with money already spent.

What changes

Spending, reserves, and goals get different row models while staying inside one shared Money plan.

The short answer

YES - KEEP FUNDING GREEN

A partial green bar means progress. Its length and amount show how complete it is. A checkmark says fully funded. Neutral grey shows what remains.

Funding asks

How much of the plan target has this month's income made available?

- Positive progress
- Never red just because income is still arriving

Usage asks

How much of the available money has already been used?

- Amber when running low
- Red only after available money is exceeded

What the strongest products reveal

Product	Pattern	Lesson for Wollie
YNAB	One optional bar combines target status, spent, available, and overspend through hue and shading.	Powerful, but it needs a legend. Do not copy yellow underfunding into proportional allocation.
Monarch	Monthly budget uses Planned / Actual / Remaining. Goals use balance, target, contribution, and projection.	Monthly availability and long-term progress are different jobs.
Monzo / N26 / Revolut / bunq	Pots, Spaces, and dedicated accounts are real separated balances.	Wollie must say 'reserved in plan' until money actually moves.
WCAG / USWDS / NN/g	Color needs a second signal; bars work best for one named quantitative idea.	Use two labeled meters and explicit amounts.

One visual grammar

Use length for quantity. Use color for categorical status. Always add words or an icon.

TOKEN	MEANING	USE
• EMERALD	Secured money and positive progress	Funding, reserve progress, goal balance
• INK	Money used or neutral actual	Normal spending
• AMBER	Attention soon	Running low; projected short
• RED	Genuine negative state	Overspent; over-allocated; overdue and short
• GREY	Remainder or not started	Unfunded track; unavailable state

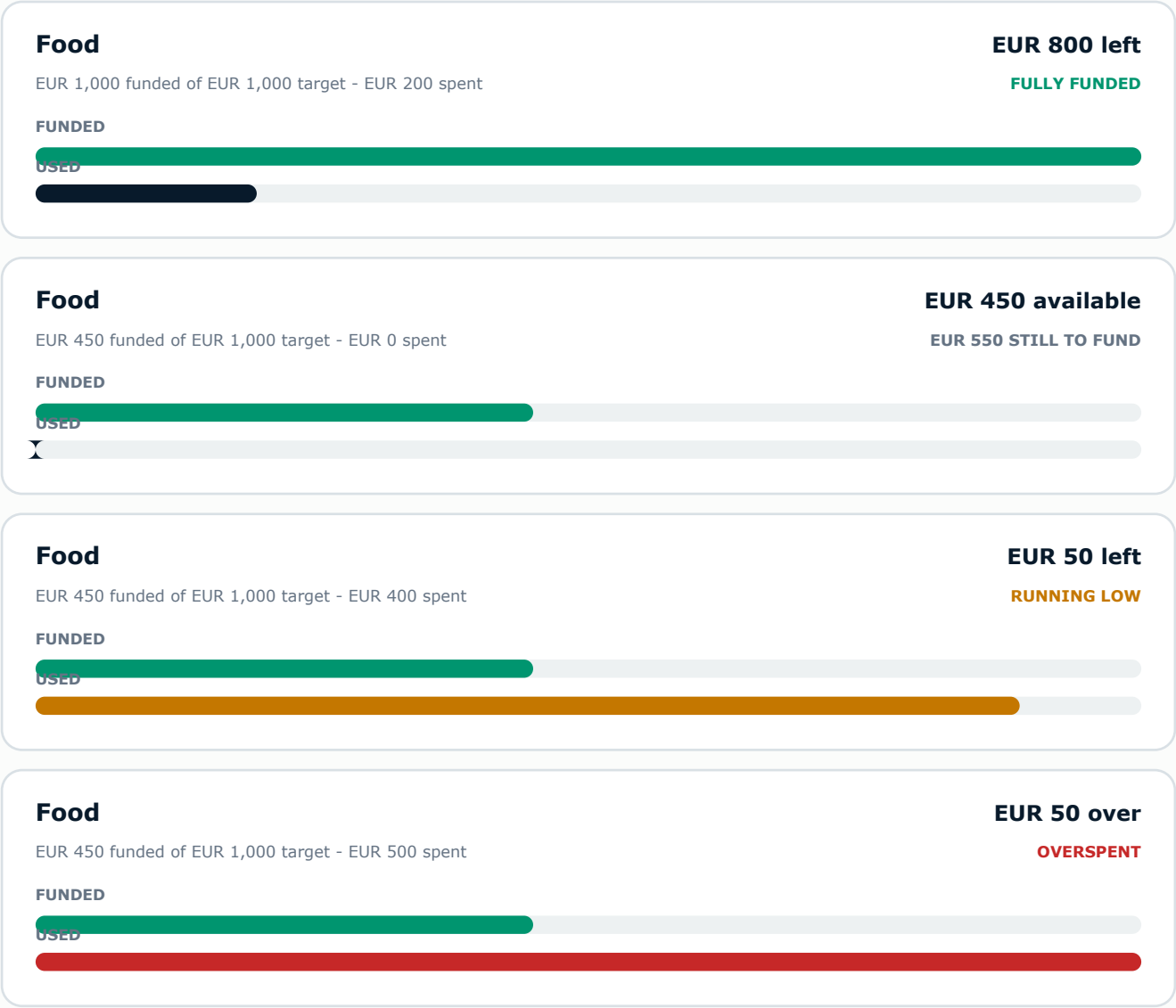
DO EUR 450 available EUR 550 still to fund	DO NOT EUR 450 left A red bar with no explanation
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Accessibility contract

- Text or an icon repeats every amber and red state.
- Meters have accessible names with amount, denominator, and status.
- Contrast remains readable in monochrome; color is never the only clue.

Spending envelopes: show both answers

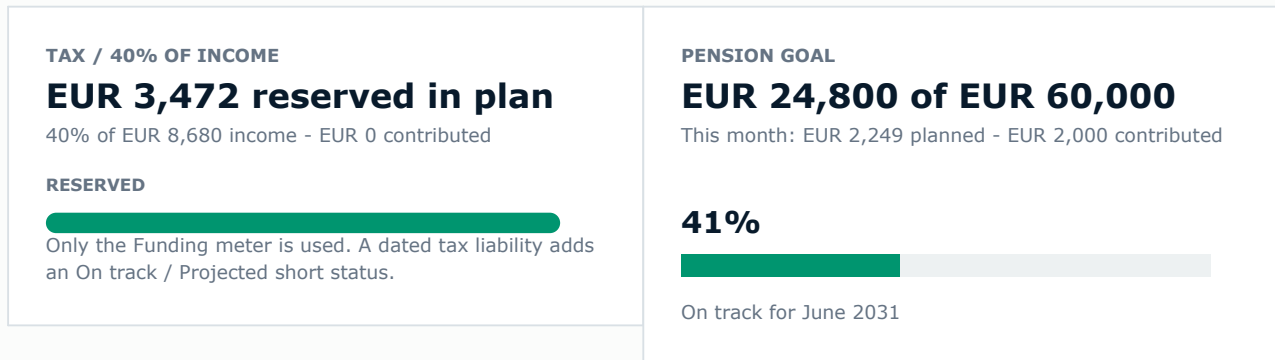
The primary number is what the household can still spend. Funding and usage sit below as two thin, labeled meters.



Threshold

Start with amber when less than 20% of funded money remains. Upgrade later to a pace-aware warning using day of month and category history. Partial funding itself remains neutral.

Reserves and goals need different truth



The language contract

Word	Use only when
Funded	Income is assigned inside the monthly plan.
Reserved in plan	Money is virtually earmarked but has not necessarily moved.
Contributed	A real transfer, pension payment, or goal-linked transaction is observed.
Goal balance	A real linked account balance or reconciled saved amount backs it.
Spent	A real household purchase or bill consumed value.

A pension transfer is saved/invested, not spent.

Market growth changes goal balance but is not a contribution.

The page and chart system

Keep one Money plan page. Split it into Spend this month and Goals & reserves. Both use the same income, but they answer different questions.

Overview allocation



● **Spent**
EUR 2,080

● **Available**
EUR 2,170

● **Reserved**
EUR 4,166

● **Unallocated**
EUR 264

The segments are mutually exclusive: income equals spent + available + reserved + unallocated. Transfers are excluded. Contributions sit in reserved/saved, never in spent.

Spending category detail

- Six-month bars: Target vs Spent
- Summary: average and variance
- Filtered transactions below
- Optional rollover history

Goal detail

- Balance timeline
- Target reference + target date
- Dotted projection
- Contribution / withdrawal markers

CHART RULE

Use sorted bars for category comparison and lines for change over time. Avoid a pie chart for progress. If a one-month composition is shown, a bar list remains easier to compare.

One transaction, one role

This is the engineering rule that keeps every chart honest.

INCOME	Adds money to allocate	Salary, business income
EXPENSE	Reduces a spending envelope	Groceries, rent, travel purchase
CONTRIBUTION	Builds a reserve or goal	Pension payment, savings transfer
TRANSFER	Moves household money only	Card repayment, own-account transfer

CARD PURCHASE

EUR 200 groceries

Expense -> Food used increases by EUR 200

CARD REPAYMENT

EUR 200 payment

Transfer -> ignored by spend and income

Result

Food shows EUR 200 used once. The repayment cannot double count it. A pension contribution appears in Saved/invested, not Spent this month.

Build sequence

01	Correct the data meaning Add spending / reserve / goal purpose. Split funding progress, usage state, and schedule risk.
02	Replace the row Render two meters for spending; reserve and goal templates for long-term money.
03	Fix summaries Use available, reserved, saved/invested, and unallocated. Exclude transfers and contributions from spend.
04	Add intelligence Percent-of-income reserves, account-backed goals, target-date projections, and pace-aware warnings.

Non-negotiable acceptance checks

- 45% funded with no spend is green + grey, never amber or red.
- EUR 1,000 funded and EUR 200 spent says EUR 800 left.
- EUR 500 spent from EUR 450 available says EUR 50 over and is red.
- Virtual Tax says Reserved in plan; a real matched movement says Contributed.
- Pension, savings, card repayments, and own-account transfers do not inflate Spent.

Sources and limits

Primary product documentation is current through 29 August 2026. Forum evidence is used only to identify confusion patterns, not to estimate prevalence.

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10. [bunq - Money Insights](https://help.bunq.com/articles/your-budgeting-screen)
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VALIDATION STILL NEEDED

**Run a five-person household usability test before broad rollout.
Ask each person to find: funded amount, available amount,
whether money actually moved, and whether action is needed.**